

TRUE NORTH

The Pattern Audit

A Shadow Work Workbook

Most people try to change what they do.

This workbook goes deeper than that.

The Circle of Return

Before You Begin

This is not a test.

There are no right answers.

There is only the truth you are willing to look at.

This workbook follows the exact sequence used in deep shadow work and behavioural analysis.

Each step builds on the last. Do not skip ahead. Do not rush.

Two ways to use this:

1. Write directly on these pages. Every prompt has writing space.
2. Use your own journal alongside it. The questions and guidance stand alone.

Here is what I want you to know before you begin.

You are not broken. You are not bad. You have simply been running a programme that was written for a younger, more afraid version of you. The work here is not about fixing yourself. It is about seeing yourself clearly, possibly for the first time.

Some of what you find will be uncomfortable, but that discomfort is not a signal to stop. It is evidence that you are finally looking in the right direction.

Take your time with each step. There is no rush.

The pattern has waited years to be seen so give it the attention it deserves.

NOTE:

The mind is brilliant at protecting you from uncomfortable truths. It will dress up avoidance as wisdom, procrastination as strategy, and fear as caution.

The only person you can lie to in this workbook is yourself...

And that is the one person you cannot afford to.

Give yourself at least 30 to 45 minutes without interruption. Put your phone down. Find somewhere quiet. Make a drink.

You are about to do something most people never do.

The Seven Steps

Here is where this audit takes you.

01

The Repeating Behaviour

What keeps showing up, even though you know better.

02

The Trigger

The moment right before the behaviour happens.

03

The Emotional Reaction

The feeling that fuels the pattern.

04

The Internal Story

What your mind tells you in that moment.

05

The Hidden Payoff

What the pattern is actually protecting you from.

06

The Deeper Fear

The identity belief underneath it all.

07

The Full Picture

Where this same pattern runs elsewhere in your life.

What Keeps Repeating?

We start with what can be observed. Not the feelings around it, not the reasons for it.
Just the behaviour itself, named clearly and honestly.

The mind will want to justify, explain, or soften what it writes here. Do not let it. Just name the behaviour - raw and straight.

What is one behaviour in your life that keeps repeating, even though you know it does not serve you?

Write it down as plainly as you can. No story around it yet. Just the pattern itself.

OTHERS HAVE WRITTEN THINGS LIKE:

- I procrastinate on opportunities that actually matter to me
- I react emotionally in conversations and say things I later regret
- I sabotage my own momentum just as things start working
- I avoid conversations I know I need to have
- I retreat when someone gets close

YOUR RESPONSE

[illegible]

True North Says...

‘It takes more honesty than most people are willing to give to look at a pattern and call it what it is. The fact that you are here, writing this, already puts you ahead of the version of yourself that is scared and would rather look away.’

What Does Your Mind Say?

This is where unconscious beliefs start to surface. In the moment the trigger lands and the emotion rises, your mind tells you something. It is automatic. You probably do not even notice it consciously, but it is there every time.

These are not deliberate thoughts. They are automatic narratives that have been running since before you could question them. They often reveal the belief that drives the entire pattern.

In that moment, what does your mind say to you?

Return to the trigger situation in your mind. Imagine it as clearly as you can. As the emotion rises, listen for the thought that follows. Write it down word for word if you can.

OTHERS HAVE WRITTEN THINGS LIKE:

- This probably will not work anyway
- They do not respect me
- I am not ready for this
- Something will go wrong
- I already know how this ends

YOUR RESPONSE

[illegible]

True North Says...

‘That thought has been running in the background for a long time. The fact that it feels true does not make it true. It simply means it has been practised, it’s a habitual thought..

Understanding where that story came from is some of the most powerful work a person can do.'

What Is It Protecting You From?

This is where shadow work becomes powerful. Every destructive pattern protects something. Patterns do not persist for no reason. They survive because on some level, they are still doing a job.

What would you have to face if this pattern were not available to you? What would you be exposed to? What would you have to feel?

What does this behaviour protect you from?

Think about what would happen if the pattern were not there. Write down whatever comes, even if it feels irrational.

OTHERS HAVE WRITTEN THINGS LIKE:

- The risk of genuinely failing at something that matters
- The risk of succeeding and the expectations that follow
- Being truly seen by someone
- Disappointing people I care about
- Losing control of a situation
- Feeling vulnerable or open

YOUR RESPONSE

What Would It Say About You?

Now we reach the layer most people never look at. Underneath the behaviour, the trigger, the emotion, the story, and the payoff, there is a belief about identity. A story about what it would mean - about who you are - if the worst happened.

This is the identity belief underneath the pattern. It is the one that keeps everything else in place. When you find it, you find the root.

If this situation went wrong, what would it mean?

Not what it would mean practically. What would it say about the kind of person you are? Go to the most uncomfortable answer. That is usually the real one.

OTHERS HAVE WRITTEN THINGS LIKE:

- It would confirm that I am not good enough
- It would prove that I am not worthy of respect
- It would show that I am not capable of the life I want
- It would confirm what I have always secretly feared about myself

YOUR RESPONSE

[illegible]

Where Else Does This Live?

This is the question that changes everything.

You have just mapped one pattern in one area of your life. Now look wider. In my experience, it is never just one place. The same core pattern, the same fear, the same story tends to run through relationships, career, money, and self-worth all at once.

Different situations. Same emotional response. Same internal story. Once you see that, the blind spot is no longer blind.

Where else in my life does this exact pattern appear?

Think about:

- Your closest relationships
- Your work or career
- Your relationship with money
- Your relationship with your own body and health
- Friendships and social situations
- How you behave when things start going well

MAP IT OUT HERE

Bringing It All Together

You have just done something most people never do.

You have not just identified a behaviour. You have traced it back through the trigger, the emotion, the story, the hidden payoff, and the identity belief sitting underneath all of it.

That is the system. And now that you can see it, everything changes.

Your pattern in one place

Write it out in your own words. The behaviour, the trigger, the emotion, what your mind says, what it protects you from, the fear underneath, where it runs.

[illegible]

[illegible]

Now answer this honestly.

What is one thing this audit has shown you that you can no longer unsee?

[illegible]

What would your life look like if this pattern no longer ran the show?

[illegible]

What now?

Seeing the pattern is the beginning, not the end.

Knowledge without integration is just information you are collecting to avoid actually changing.

The real work is somatic. It lives in the body. The pattern was written into your nervous system over years of experience, and that is where it needs to be met and released.

That is exactly what we'll be doing inside The Circle of Return.

The CoR is not a coaching programme. It is not a community. It is a commitment to yourself, to real shifts, and to an energetic field you will connect with before every session.

Now it is time to go deeper... You felt the pull, and this audit has confirmed what you already knew.

Where you are now does not have to be where you end up.

— True North